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A

weekend that demanded perfection. A series of bold overtakes, where the smallest misstep could have cost everything. And a champion's drive, unyielding when the stakes were highest. After 58 laps of pursuit around the storied Yas Marina circuit, Lando Norris claimed his place in history as Formula One's new king.

Heading into the finale with a razor-thin lead over Max Verstappen and Oscar Piastri, Norris knew steady laps mattered, but composure under pressure mattered more. A gritty third-place finish, when fourth would have spelt disaster, secured McLaren its first drivers' crown in 17 years.

It was also the culmination of Norris' 16-year dream, sparked in karting tracks, sharpened through turbulent junior formulas and finally

realised under Abu Dhabi's floodlights. It capped a rare trifecta of a home win at Silverstone, a tour de force in Monaco, and the world championship in a single season.

The emotion within the cockpit and across the paddock was palpable. The gruelling 24-race journey reached its end in a victory shaped by family sacrifices and personal setbacks, weaving together the strands of a story long in the making.

The path to glory in 2025 was not